

A GAME-BASED RECRUITMENT ASSESSMENT

VECTRA

One real scenario. An explainable score.

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THE PROBLEM

Hiring runs on thin evidence

Most of what a recruiter has to go on before deciding doesn't actually show how someone behaves under pressure.

CV

What the candidate says they did

Interview

How well they tell a story — often a rehearsed one

Aptitude test

Puzzle-solving speed, not judgment when things go wrong

The traits that matter most — judgment under pressure, ownership, composure — only show up in behavior. Behavior is exactly what none of these three can show.

Where existing game-based assessments fall short

01

Invisible Job Relevance

Candidates pop balloons or sort cards with no visible link to the role — low face validity, low candidate trust.

02

Unexplainable Scoring

A trait score comes out of a black-box model nobody, including the employer, can fully explain.

03

Disconnected Snapshots

Five isolated 90-second games measure traits alone — not judgment across a sequence of real decisions.

What VECTRA does differently

● **One continuous scenario**

Not five unrelated mini-games — a single branching crisis that evolves with each decision.

● **Rubric written in advance**

Every decision point is scored before a candidate ever plays. No hidden model, no post-hoc justification.

● **Reflection checked against behavior**

Candidates explain what they did in their own words — cross-checked against what was actually logged.

One branching crisis, five stages

Role: Project Manager. A vendor API change breaks the payments integration — three days before launch.

1

Investigate

Check the tracker, then
Engineering

2

Scope Decision

Trade speed against quality

3

Pressure

A director asks to downplay
risk

4

Fallout

Earlier choices shape who
shows up

5

Reflection

Explain it in their own words

Every score traces to a table, not a model

The director asks the candidate to tell the steering committee the launch is “on track,” leaving out a known vendor risk.

Candidate's choice	Ownership	Composure	Escalation Judg.
Refuses — tells the truth	+8	+6	+6
Complies — says it's fine	-6	-4	—
Partial — note sent after	+4	+4	—

Nothing is scored by a hidden model. Every score is a row in a table a recruiter can read.

What the recruiter sees

- Live trait scores, with the exact rubric row behind the last change
- A full event log of what the candidate did, in order
- Reflection-consistency check — flags a gap for human review, never auto-decides
- Bookmarking — flag any moment to revisit later
- End-of-session scoreboard with the full breakdown

Nothing in this panel makes a hiring decision — it gives a human reviewer a traceable basis for their own.

Three fixes that came from actually playing it

Removed a timed decision

A countdown made the data noisier — a careful thinker and a panicked guesser looked identical once the clock ran out.

Split the reflection check into two signals

A mismatch could mean misrepresentation, or it could mean modesty. Those shouldn't be flagged the same way.

Rescaled the scoreboard grade

With only 3 scored decisions, the best possible raw score was 62/100 — so S and D were mathematically unreachable. Now graded against the scenario's real best/worst case.

WHAT THIS IS NOT, YET

Stated plainly, on purpose

One scenario, one role — the structure is role-agnostic, only Project Manager is built

Not validated against real job performance

Recruiter view is a demo toggle, not a separate secure session

Rubric reflects my own design judgment, not a validated psychometric instrument

Legal and compliance review not yet done

Opaque hiring algorithms are under real pressure

● EU AI Act

Classifies employment-related AI as “high-risk,” requiring transparency and human oversight.

● US disclosure laws

Colorado and Illinois now require disclosure specifically for AI tools used in hiring.

● Real litigation

A 2026 class action against an AI hiring vendor alleged applicants were scored without disclosure.

VECTRA has no machine-learning model — it's a fixed, readable rubric. That's a fundamentally easier thing to explain and defend, and it's a candidate-experience issue as much as a compliance one.

CLOSE

Built independently, as a people-analytics project

Designed the scenario, trait rubric, and scoring logic myself. Technical build assisted by Claude.

GitHub: github.com/annweshach/vectra-game-based-assessment

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